

DESKCHARM GUIDE

DeskCharm

The complete guide — using and developing DeskCharm

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> DeskCharm hangs a small charm from the top of your screen. Little visitors walk along your taskbar. Gentle tools help you breathe, focus, drink water and take breaks. Everything runs on your own PC.

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PART 1

Using DeskCharm

For everyone who uses DeskCharm: install it, play with it and make it yours.



1

CHAPTER 1

What DeskCharm is

A small companion that hangs from the top of your screen.

DeskCharm is a small desktop companion for Windows.

- **A charm** hangs on a string from the top corner of your screen. It swings when you move past it. You can grab it, fling it, squeeze it and slide its beads.
- **Desk visitors** are small characters (a cat, a baby elephant, Vijay the water buddy and more). Now and then one walks along the top of your taskbar, does a little act and leaves.
- **Calm tools** help you through the day: guided breathing, a focus timer with tasks, break and eye-rest reminders, a water reminder, stretch and posture nudges, a daily mood check-in, a daily ritual, ambient sounds and your own reminders.
- **Insights** show your calm minutes, breaks, water, mood and streak.

> **NOTE**
> The charm lives in a see-through window that covers your screen. Clicks pass through it to whatever is underneath. Only the charm itself (and visitors, buttons and faces it shows) catch the mouse.



Figure 1 — The charm hanging from the top-right corner of the screen.

SECTION 1.1

Privacy in one paragraph

PRIVACY

Your settings, tasks, reminders and insights are saved as files on your PC. DeskCharm has no account, no analytics and no tracking. The only times it uses the internet are: the update check (GitHub, every 6 hours), **Live weather wind** if you turn it on (your approximate location from your IP address, then the wind speed from Open-Meteo), and **Quiet during busy calendar events** if you turn it on and paste a calendar link (it downloads that calendar). **Report a problem** opens a pre-filled page in your browser; nothing is sent until you submit it yourself.

SECTION 1.2

DeskCharm Pro

DeskCharm is free. **DeskCharm Pro** is a one-time **lifetime licence** for your own use on up to 3 PCs. No subscription, no account.

Free	Pro
Nazar and Gods charms, plus one Pro pack free each month	all charm packs, all the time
1 custom charm (your own PNG)	unlimited custom charms
all visitors, including festival visitors	**Two charms** (themes as pairs)
themes with one charm	Insights full history + **This week** card
every calm tool: breathing, focus, breaks, water, posture, mood, reminders, mic-based meeting quiet	**Focus guard** and **Calendar quiet**
Insights for the last 7 days	

- **Trial:** every install gets all of Pro for **7 days**. When it ends nothing is deleted: Pro-only things just switch off or grey out, and come back the moment you add a licence.
- **Price:** ₹69 for launch, then ₹99, one time. The price is in Indian rupees; if your card is from another country, your bank converts it (cards from outside India are coming soon). 7-day no-questions refund.
- **How to buy: Settings › General › DeskCharm Pro › Buy Pro** opens **deskcharm.in/pricing.html**. Enter your name, email and phone, then pay with UPI, card or netbanking through Razorpay. Your licence key is shown on the page and emailed to you from **support@deskcharm.in**. Lost it? Use **Find my key** on the website (your email + Razorpay payment id), or email support@deskcharm.in. (A Microsoft Store version may come later.)

- **Enter a licence key: Settings › General › DeskCharm Pro › Enter licence key**, paste the key (`DC1-…`) and confirm.

> **PRIVACY**
> The key is checked **offline** on your PC with a built-in public key. DeskCharm does not contact any server, does not need an account and does not read a hardware id. The key is saved in `license.json` in your DeskCharm folder and included in backups.



2

CHAPTER 2

Install, start, update and uninstall

Getting DeskCharm onto your PC — and off it again.

SECTION 2.1

Install

1. Download the installer (`DeskCharm_1.8.0_x64-setup.exe`) from **deskcharm.in** or the GitHub releases page (github.com/tharuneshwar-s/deskcharm-releases/releases/latest).
2. Run it. It installs for your user only. You do not need administrator rights.

> ⚠ **WARNING**
> The build is not signed with a code-signing certificate, so Windows SmartScreen may show **Windows protected your PC**. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. To check the file, compare PowerShell `Get-FileHash` with the SHA-256 listed on the release page.

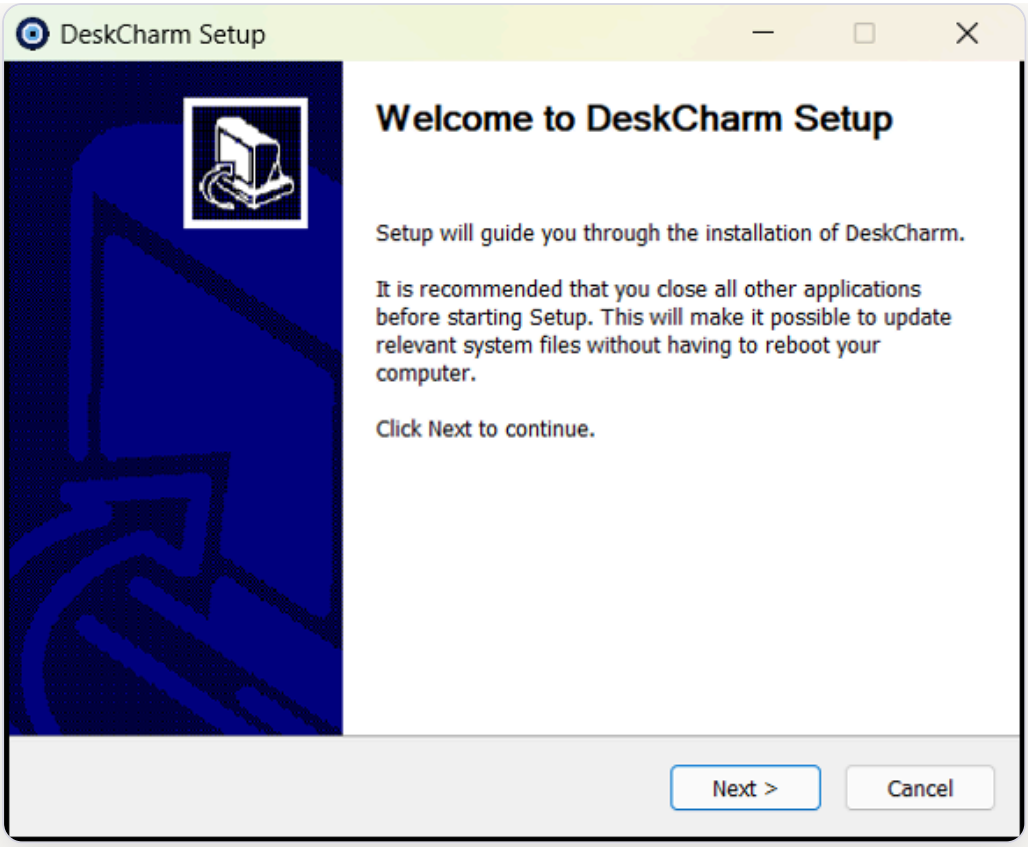


Figure 2 — The first page of the DeskCharm installer.

SECTION 2.2

Start

- DeskCharm starts after installing. The charm appears in the top-right corner.
- The first time, the charm shows three short tips: **Grab me and fling**, **Rest your cursor on me**, **Right-click me**. Each one moves on when you do it. Click the small **×** to skip them.
- DeskCharm runs only once. If you start it again while it is running, the running copy opens **Settings** instead of adding a second charm.
- To start it when you sign in, turn on **Settings › General › Start with Windows**.

SECTION 2.3

The tray icon

DeskCharm has an icon in the system tray (near the clock).

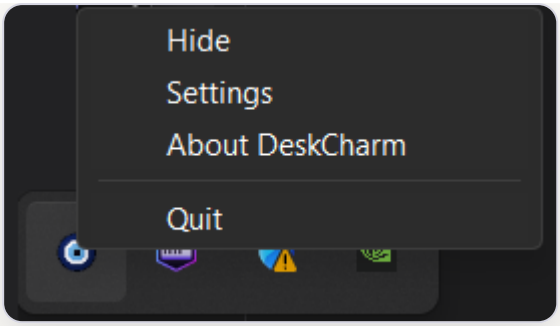


Figure 3 — The DeskCharm tray icon and its right-click menu.

Action	What happens
Left-click the icon	Opens Settings
Right-click › **Hide** / **Show**	Hides or shows the charm
Right-click › **Settings**	Opens Settings
Right-click › **About DeskCharm**	Opens Settings on the General page
Right-click › **Quit**	Closes DeskCharm

> **TIP**
> **Ctrl+Shift+D** shows or hides the charm from any app. If another app already uses this shortcut, Settings › General says so.

SECTION 2.4

Update

DeskCharm checks GitHub for a new version when it starts (after about 20 seconds) and then every 6 hours. If one is found, a small cue appears near the charm and **Settings › General › Updates** shows an **Install** button. Nothing is installed until you click it. You can also click **Check now**.

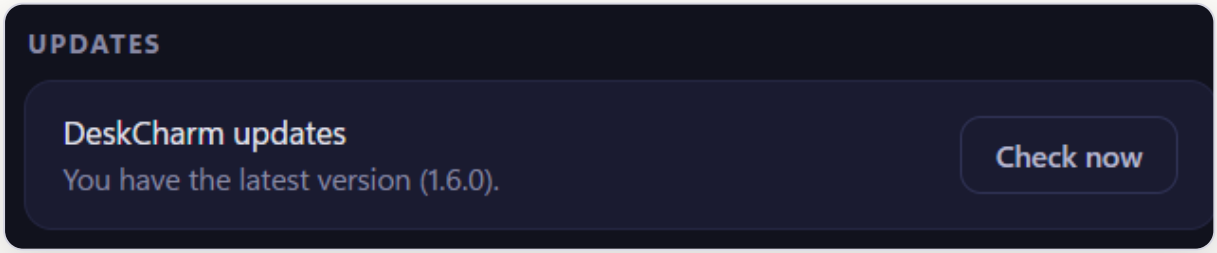


Figure 4 — Settings › General › Updates.

SECTION 2.5

Uninstall

Open Windows **Settings › Apps › Installed apps**, find **DeskCharm** and choose **Uninstall**.

> ⚠ **WARNING**
> The uninstaller also deletes your DeskCharm data folder (`%APPDATA%\com.deskcharm.desktop`) and the start-with-Windows entry. Export a backup first (Settings › General › Backup & logs) if you may come back.

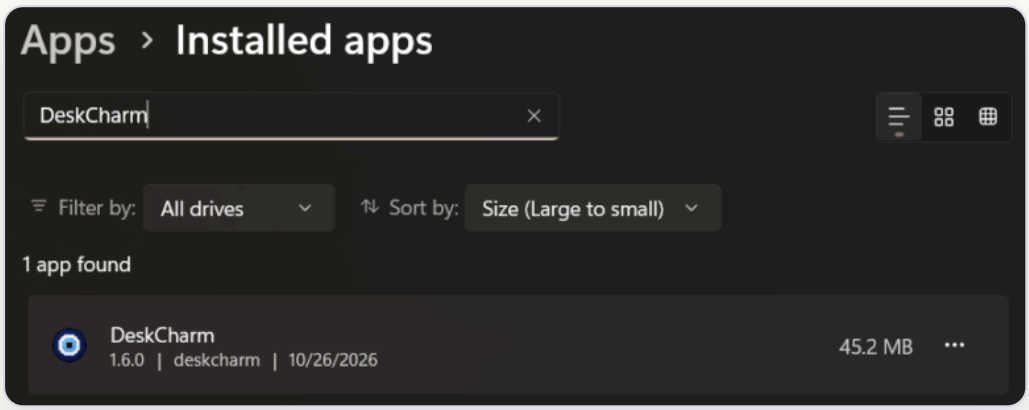


Figure 5 — DeskCharm in Windows Settings › Apps › Installed apps. The ⋯ button holds Uninstall.



3

CHAPTER 3

The charm

Touch, play, the quick menu and the living face.

SECTION 3.1

Touch and play

You do	The charm does
Move the cursor past it	Swings (if **Swing when the cursor passes** is on)
Grab and drag	Follows your hand; the grabbed spot stays under the cursor
Let go while moving	Flies off and swings back (a fling)
Press and hold	Squeezes
Grab a bead and drag	The bead slides along the string
Rest the cursor on it	A soft **breathing glow** (in 4 s, out 6 s). If you set today's intention, it shows here
Double-click	Rings a bell
Click quickly several times	**Smash to calm**: a ring fills around the charm; when full it bursts into sparkles and a calming chord, and the charm settles
Middle-click	Sends a visitor
Right-click	Opens the quick menu
Fling it round the hook	It winds round the hook and unwinds

Some features use a single click on the charm too: it ends a break reminder early, answers "Done?" for a focus task, or starts breathing after a low mood or at wind-down time.



Figure 6 — Grab and drag: the string bends and the charm follows the cursor.



Figure 7 — A fling: after you let go, the charm swings across and back.

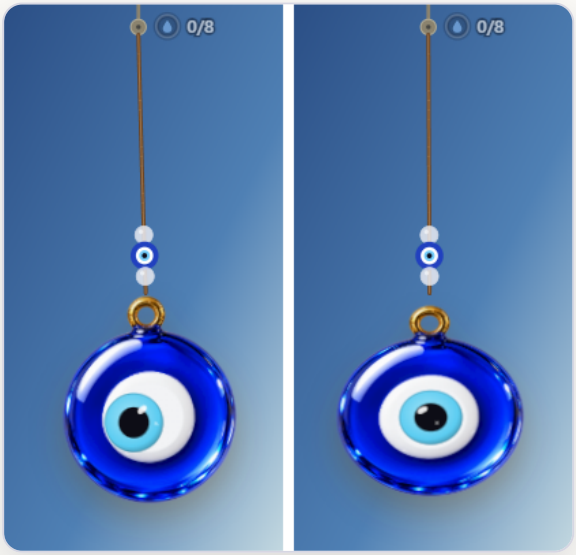


Figure 8 — Press and hold: the charm at rest (left) and squeezed (right).

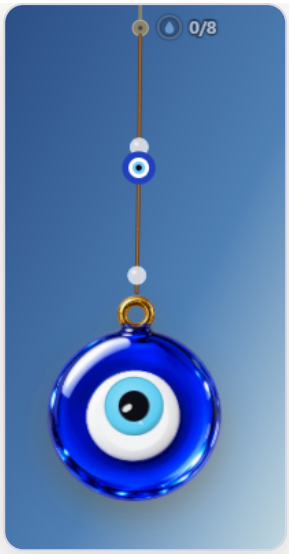


Figure 9 — A bead slid up the string.



Figure 10 — Smash to calm: the ring fills around the charm with each quick click.

SECTION 3.2

The quick menu (right-click)

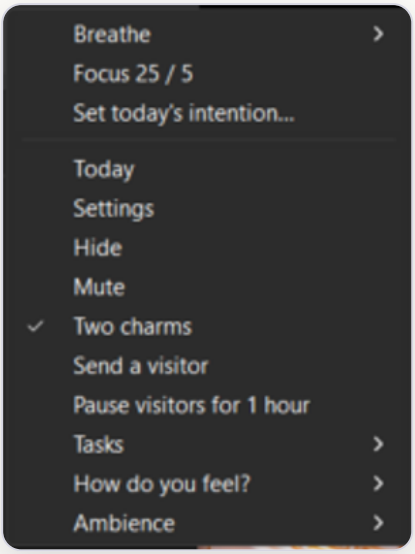


Figure 11 — The right-click quick menu.

The menu is built fresh each time, so it always matches what is running. From top to bottom:

Item	What it does
Breathe ▸ 1 min / 3 min / 5 min	Starts guided breathing. While breathing runs, it is **Stop breathing** instead
Focus 25 / 5	Starts the focus timer. While it runs, **Stop focus**
Set today's intention...	Opens Settings so you can type today's intention (only when **Today's intention** is on)
Today	Shows today's calm summary and streak beside the charm
Settings	Opens Settings
Hide	Hides the charm (show it again with Ctrl+Shift+D or the tray)
Mute / **Unmute**	Turns every DeskCharm sound off or on
Two charms (tick)	Adds or removes the second charm
Send a visitor	A visitor walks in now
Pause visitors for 1 hour / **Resume visitors**	Stops scheduled visitors for an hour
Tasks ▸	**✓ Done: ...** (the current task, during focus), **Focus on a new task...**, and up to a few open tasks (**▶ task**) to start focusing on
How do you feel? ▸	😞 Rough · 😟 Low · 😐 Okay · 🙂 Good · 😄 Great — logs your mood
Ambience ▸	Off · Rain · Wind · Ocean · Temple · Chimes (ticked = current)

SECTION 3.3

One or two charms

You can hang a second charm. Turn it on with **Two charms** in the quick menu, or **Settings › Charm › Charms: Two**. Pick it under the **Charm 2** tab. It can hang **Beside** the first (close enough to clink) or from the **Opposite corner**. It has its own size and string length. If you turn Two on without choosing, DeskCharm picks a partner (Toro gets Kuro).



Figure 12 — Two charms hanging side by side.

SECTION 3.4

The living eye and face

With **Living charm** on, eye charms (the nazar family) come alive. The eye follows your cursor, blinks every few seconds, looks dizzy after you spin it round the hook, opens wide after a hard fling, glances at the clock on the hour, and dozes off when you have been away for 5 minutes (1 minute late at night). The cat charms **Toro** and **Kuro** have a living cat face; click them to poke them.

With reduced motion, the eye only blinks and dozes.



Figure 13 — The living face of a cat charm.

SECTION 3.5

Charms and themes

The catalog has these families: **Nazar**, **Indian Gods**, **Zodiac**, **Crystals & gems**, **Temple**, **Birthstones**, **Lucky Charms** and **Friends** (cats, animals and Tamil film-star figurines). You can also add your own PNG images (**My charms**).

A **theme** sets both charms, the rope and beads, a soft glow and an ambient sound in one click. There are 10 themes: Temple morning, Rainy focus, Ocean calm, Cosmic, Toro & Kuro, Diwali glow, Garden, Lucky gold, Midnight and Pongal. **Cosmic** asks for your birthday (month and day) to choose your zodiac sign and birthstone.



4

CHAPTER 4

Settings tour

Every page of Settings, one by one.

Open Settings from the tray icon, the quick menu, or by starting DeskCharm again. Every change saves on its own after a moment; the status at the bottom says **Saved**. The overlay previews changes live.

There are eight pages. Defaults below are what a fresh install uses.

SECTION 4.1

Charm — "Your charm"

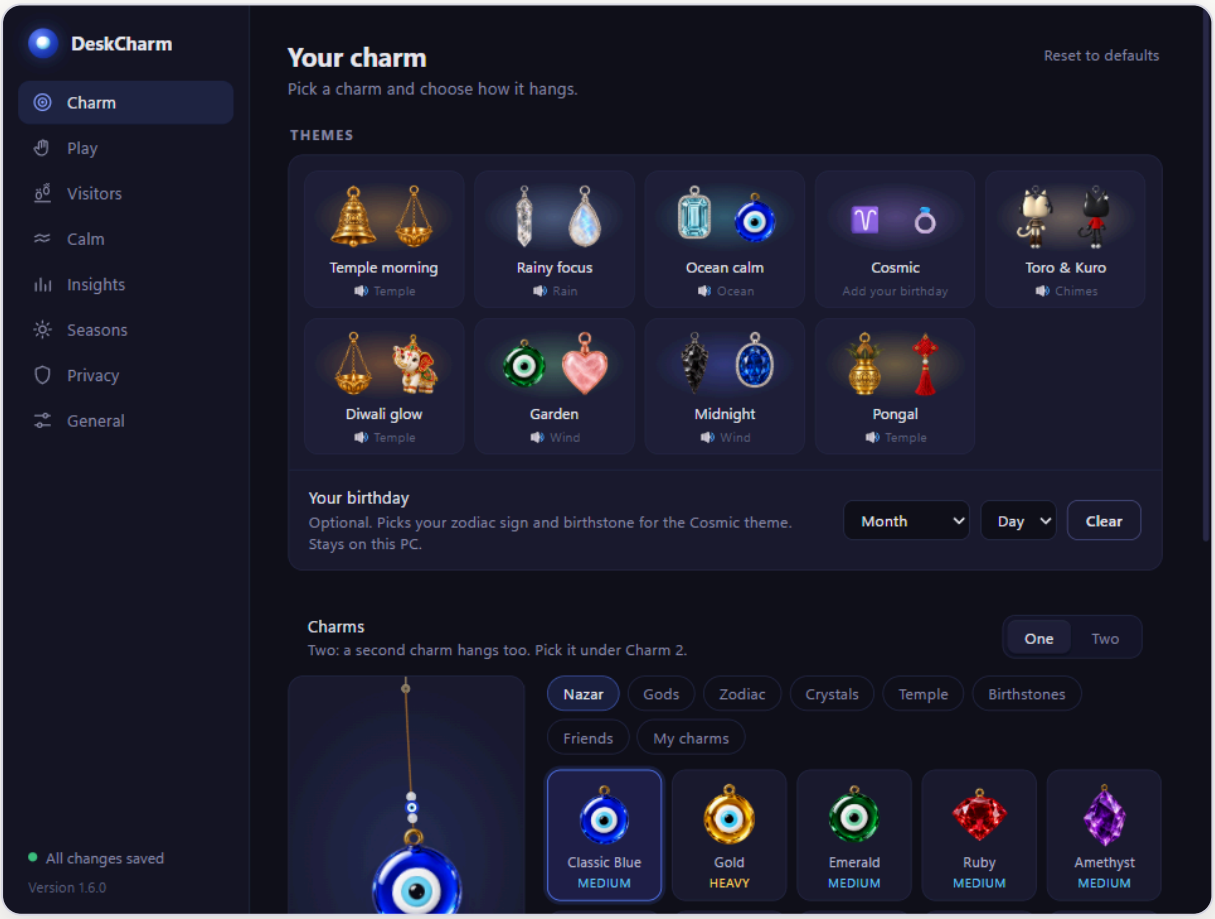


Figure 14 — Settings › Charm.

Themes (top card)

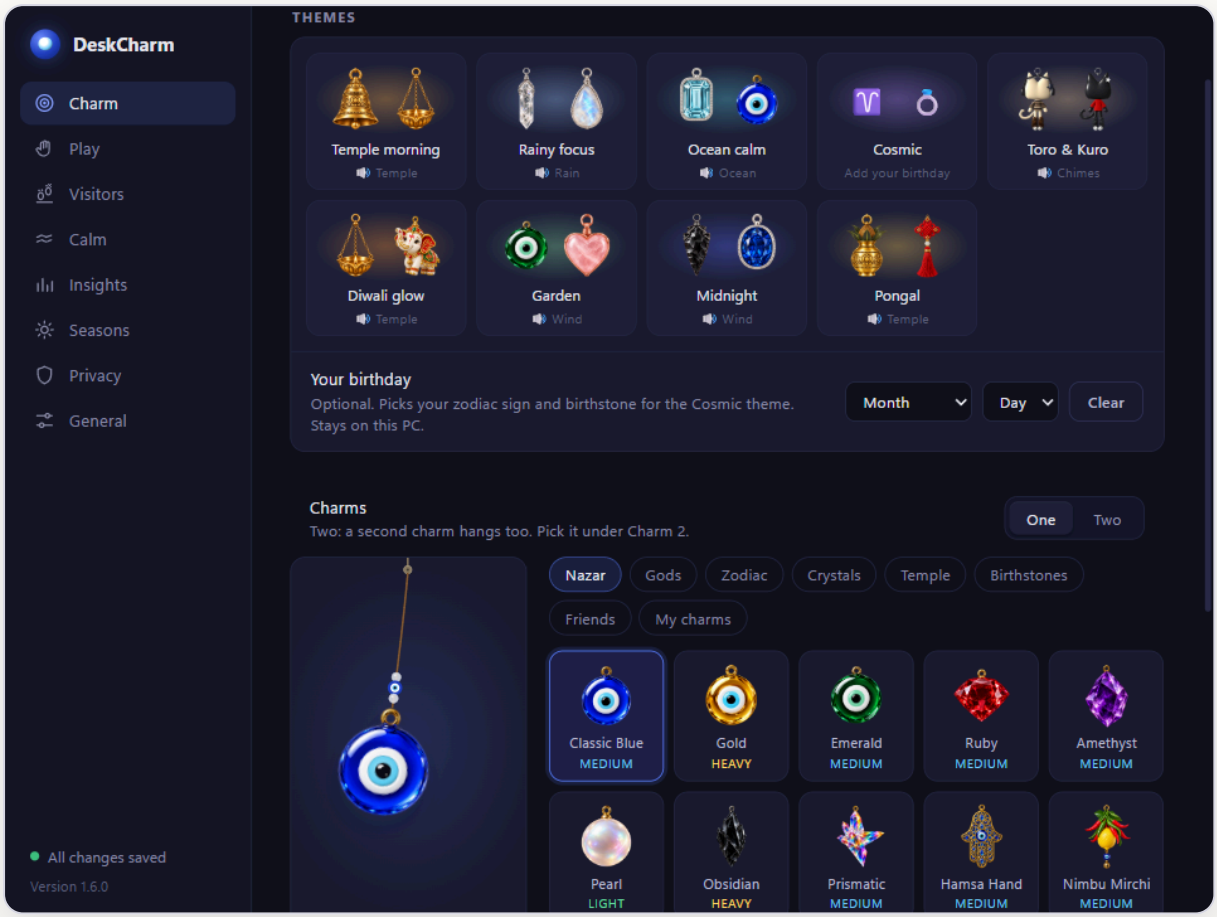


Figure 15 — Settings › Charm › Themes.

Option	What it does	Default
Theme tiles	Apply a theme (charms, rope, glow, ambience)	None
Your birthday	Month and day, used by Cosmic	Empty
Theme rope & glow › **Use charm's own**	Drops the theme's rope and glow so each charm uses its own	—

Charm picker

Option	What it does	Default
Charms: One / Two	One charm or two. Two shows **Charm 1** / **Charm 2** tabs	One
Category tabs and tiles	Pick a charm. The preview on the side can be dragged	Blue nazar
Add your own	Choose a PNG; name it; **Delete** removes it (click again to confirm)	—

How it hangs

Option	What it does	Default
Side of the screen	Left or Right top corner	Right
Charm size	50–150 %	100 %
String length	50–150 %	70 %
Opacity	20–100 %	100 %
Nudge sideways	Move the charm away from the corner (−150 to 150)	0
Second charm	Beside / Opposite corner	Beside
Charm 2 size	50–150 %	Same as charm 1
Charm 2 string length	50–150 %	Same as charm 1

SECTION 4.2

Play — "How the charm moves and responds to you"

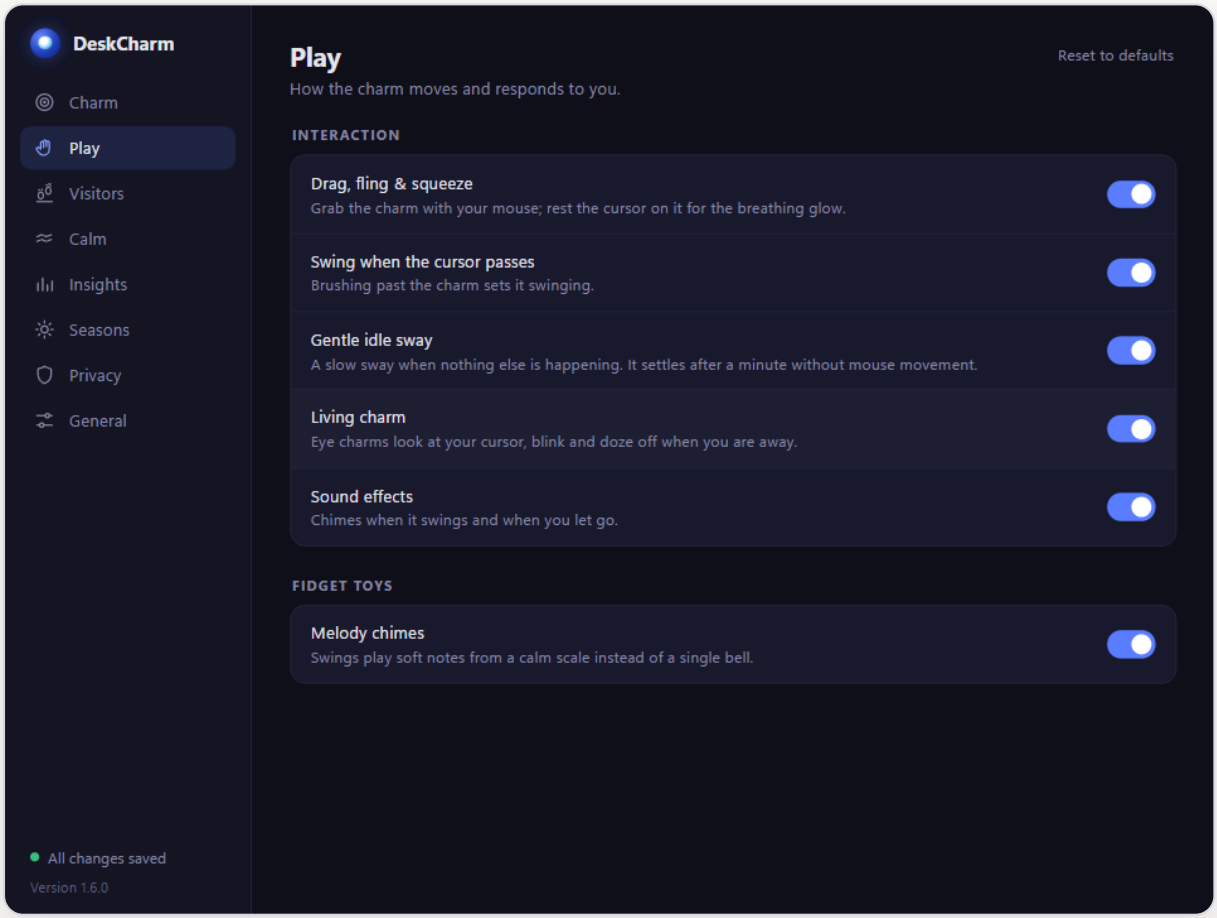


Figure 16 — Settings › Play.

Option	What it does	Default
Drag, fling & squeeze	Grab the charm; rest the cursor on it for the breathing glow	On

Option	What it does	Default
Swing when the cursor passes	Brushing past sets it swinging	On
Gentle idle sway	A slow sway; settles after a minute without mouse movement	On
Living charm	Eye charms look at you, blink and doze	On
Sound effects	Chimes when it swings and when you let go	On
Fidget toys › Melody chimes	Swings play soft notes from a calm scale instead of one bell	On

SECTION 4.3

Visitors — "Desk visitors"

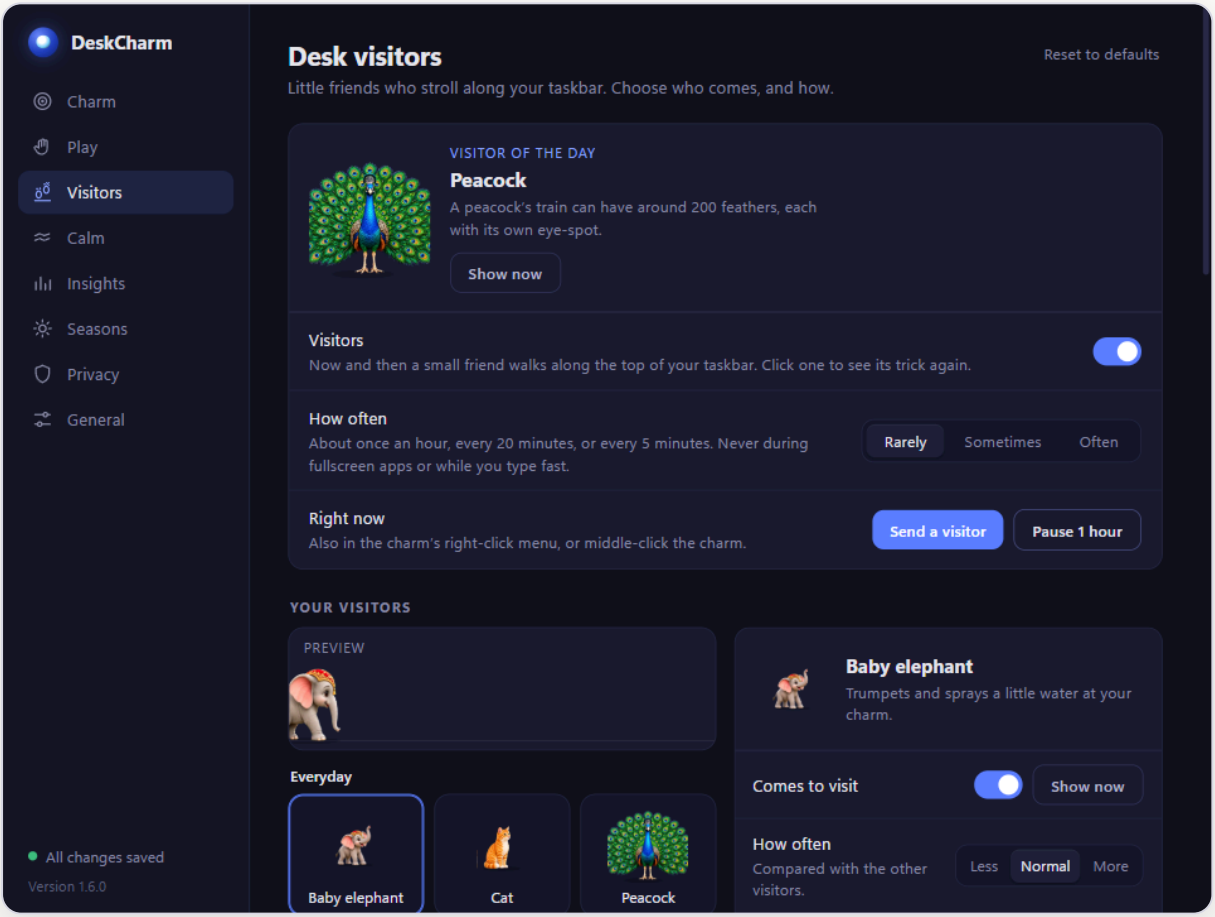


Figure 17 — Settings › Visitors.

Top card

Option	What it does	Default
Visitors	Visitors come now and then	On
How often	Rarely (about once an hour) / Sometimes (about every 20 min) / Often (about every 5 min)	Rarely

Option	What it does	Default
Right now	**Send a visitor**, **Pause 1 hour**	—

The card also shows a **Visitor of the day** with a fun fact.

Who visits for what — which visitor comes for each job: water, stretch, posture, break, eye rest, reminders (those set to *Auto*), focus guard, mood cheer, the morning hello and counters.

Option	What it does	Default
Who comes	**Auto**: the job's specialist most of the time (Vijay for water, the yogi for stretch and posture, the chai-wala for breaks, the myna for eye rest), and about one visit in four another of your everyday visitors. **Favourite**: one visitor for every job. **Custom** (Pro): pick per job	Auto
Favourite	The visitor for every job (only visitors that are switched on)	—
Per job (Custom, Pro)	Auto, any visitor that is switched on, or **Charm only** (break, eye rest, reminders, focus guard, mood cheer, morning hello)	Auto
Message (Pro)	Your own line for that job, shown exactly as typed; empty = the default line	Empty
Try it	Runs that job now (water YES really counts a glass)	—

Any visitor can do any job. A visitor without its own act for the job walks in, stops and asks the job's question with the job's buttons, and the answer counts the same: YES to water counts a glass, Done on a stretch logs it, *Take it* starts the break, eye rest shows a 20-second countdown. Without Pro, Custom works like Auto (your choices are kept).

Your visitors — a gallery grouped as everyday, wellness and festival visitors. Open one to change it just for that visitor:

Option	What it does
Comes to visit (+ **Show now**)	Include this visitor
How often	Less / Normal / More
Size	Default / S / M / L
Trick speed	Slow / Normal / Quick
Walks	Default / → / ← / Either
Stops at	Default / Left / Middle / Right / Anywhere
Sounds, bubbles, tricks, hello, dance, run away	Default / On / Off each
Look, name, greeting	Colour variant, a custom name and greeting (where offered)

Option	What it does
Hello line / Goodbye line (Pro)	What it says when it arrives (replaces the greeting) and as it leaves, exactly as typed
Times of day	Morning / Afternoon / Evening / Night — only comes on its own at these times
Visits today	How many times it came today, and when last
Reset *name*	Back to defaults for this visitor only

Defaults for every visitor

Option	What it does	Default
Size	Small / Medium / Large	Medium
Walk	Left → right / Right → left / Either	Left → right
Stop at	Left / Middle / Right / Anywhere	Middle
Sounds	Trumpets, meows and calls (Mute silences them too)	On
Speech bubbles	Visitors talk in bubbles	On
Charm tricks	Visitors may splash, nudge or borrow a bead	On
Reactions	Wave at your cursor, hop to music, run from a flung charm	On
Quiet hours	No visitors between two times (you can still send one)	Off, 22:00–07:00
Today	Today's visit log	—

SECTION 4.4

Calm — "Breathing, focus and gentle reminders"

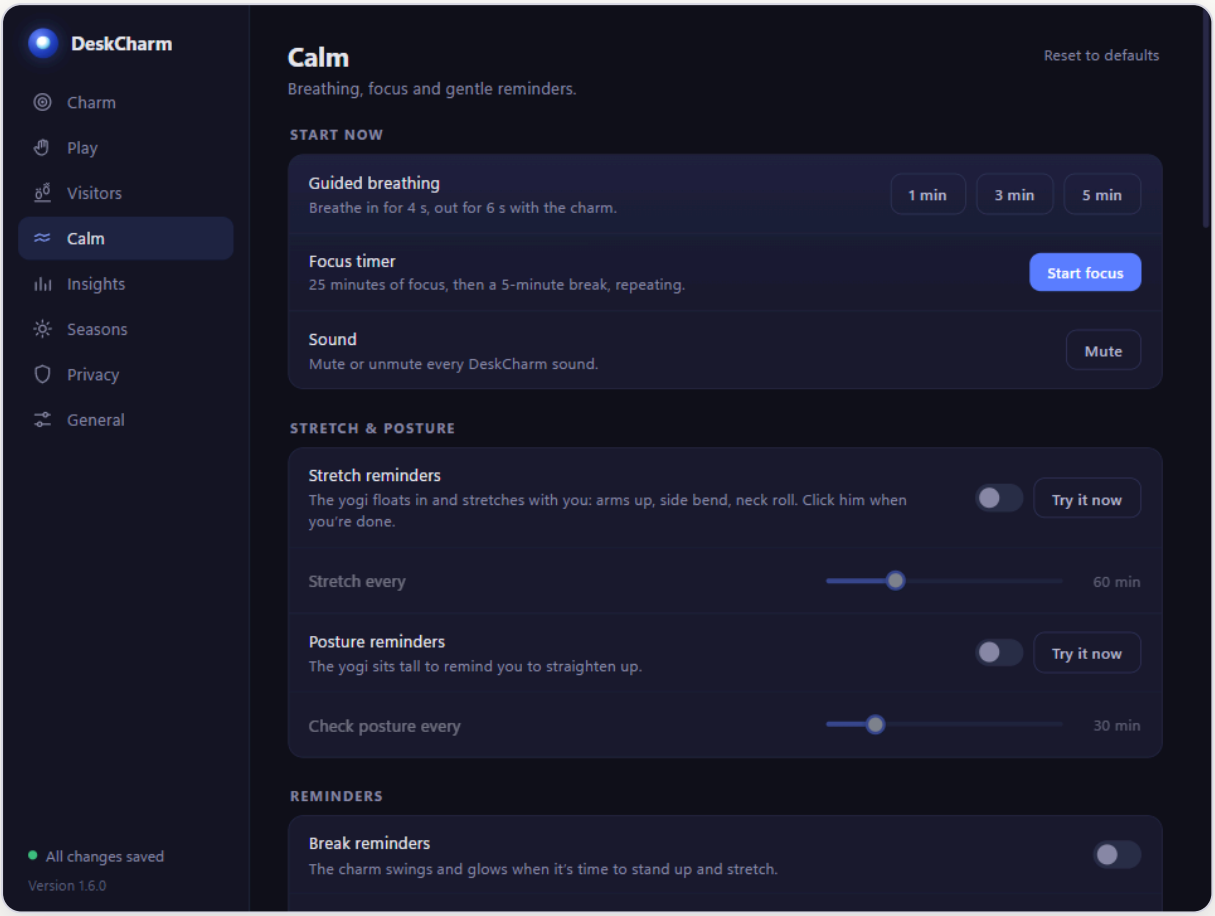


Figure 18 — Settings › Calm.

Start now: buttons for **Guided breathing** (1 / 3 / 5 min, **Stop breathing**), **Focus timer** (**Start focus** / **Stop focus**) and **Sound** (**Mute** / **Unmute**).

Reminders

Option	What it does	Default
Break reminders	The charm swings and glows when it is time to stand up; the chai-wala rides in	Off
Remind every	15–120 min	45 min
Eye rest (20-20-20)	Every 20 minutes, look 20 feet away for 20 seconds; the myna bird lands and gazes	Off
Water reminder (+ **Try it now**)	Vijay asks you to drink water	On
Ask every	15–180 min	60 min
Daily goal	4–14 glasses	8

Option	What it does	Default
Your name	What visitors call you	Empty

Stretch & posture

Option	What it does	Default
Stretch reminders (+ **Try it now**)	The yogi stretches with you; click him when done	Off
Stretch every	15–180 min	60 min
Posture reminders (+ **Try it now**)	The yogi sits tall	Off
Check posture every	10–120 min	30 min

Mood check-in

Option	What it does	Default
Ask how I feel each day	Once a day, five faces under the charm	On
Ask from	At your first activity after this time	15:00

Daily ritual

Option	What it does	Default
Morning greeting	A chime and "Good morning" at your first activity (from 05:00). With visitors on, a visitor says it	On
Today's intention	Shown when you rest the cursor on the charm; cleared at midnight	On
Intention for today	One short line	Empty
Evening wind-down	A warm glow at the time below; click the charm for 1 minute of breathing	Off
Wind down at	Time	21:30
Weekly reflection	Sunday evening card: calm minutes, breathing, breaks, water, streak, intentions	On

Ambience

Option	What it does	Default
Sound	Off / Rain / Wind / Ocean / Temple / Chimes (made live, no recordings)	Off
Listen › ▶ Preview	Hear it	—

Option	What it does	Default
Volume	0–100 %	40 %
Play during breathing & focus	Starts with a session and fades after; uses Rain if Sound is Off	On

Focus tasks: **Add a task** to a list you can pick from when focus starts.

Your reminders: **+ Add reminder**, then **Edit** / **Delete** each one (see chapter 6). Pick a visitor or **Auto** (*Who visits for what*). Tick **Track it** to record each time it is done or missed (3 tracked reminders free, unlimited with Pro).

Counters: **+ Add counter** (1 free, unlimited with Pro), then **Edit** / **Delete** (see chapter 6).

Option	What it does	Default
Name, emoji	What you count, e.g. Push-ups 💪 (up to 24 characters)	—
Daily goal	1–50	—
Ask every	15–240 min, only between **From** and **To** (may run past midnight; the same time = all day)	—
Who asks	Auto (*Who visits for what* › Counters) or a visitor	Auto
Own question (Pro)	Shown exactly as typed instead of "*name*? *emoji*"	Empty
Ring	A small ring beside the charm	On

Focus guard

Option	What it does	Default
Nudge me back to focus	During focus, a visitor nudges you when a listed app comes to the front	Off
Distracting apps	Program file names, e.g. `discord.exe` (**Add**)	Empty

Meetings

Option	What it does	Default
Quiet during calls	No visitors while your microphone is in use	On
Quiet during busy calendar events	Busy calendar times count as quiet hours	Off
Calendar link (.ics)	Your calendar's private iCal address; **Test** checks it	Empty

SECTION 4.5

Insights — "Your calm minutes, breaks and streak"

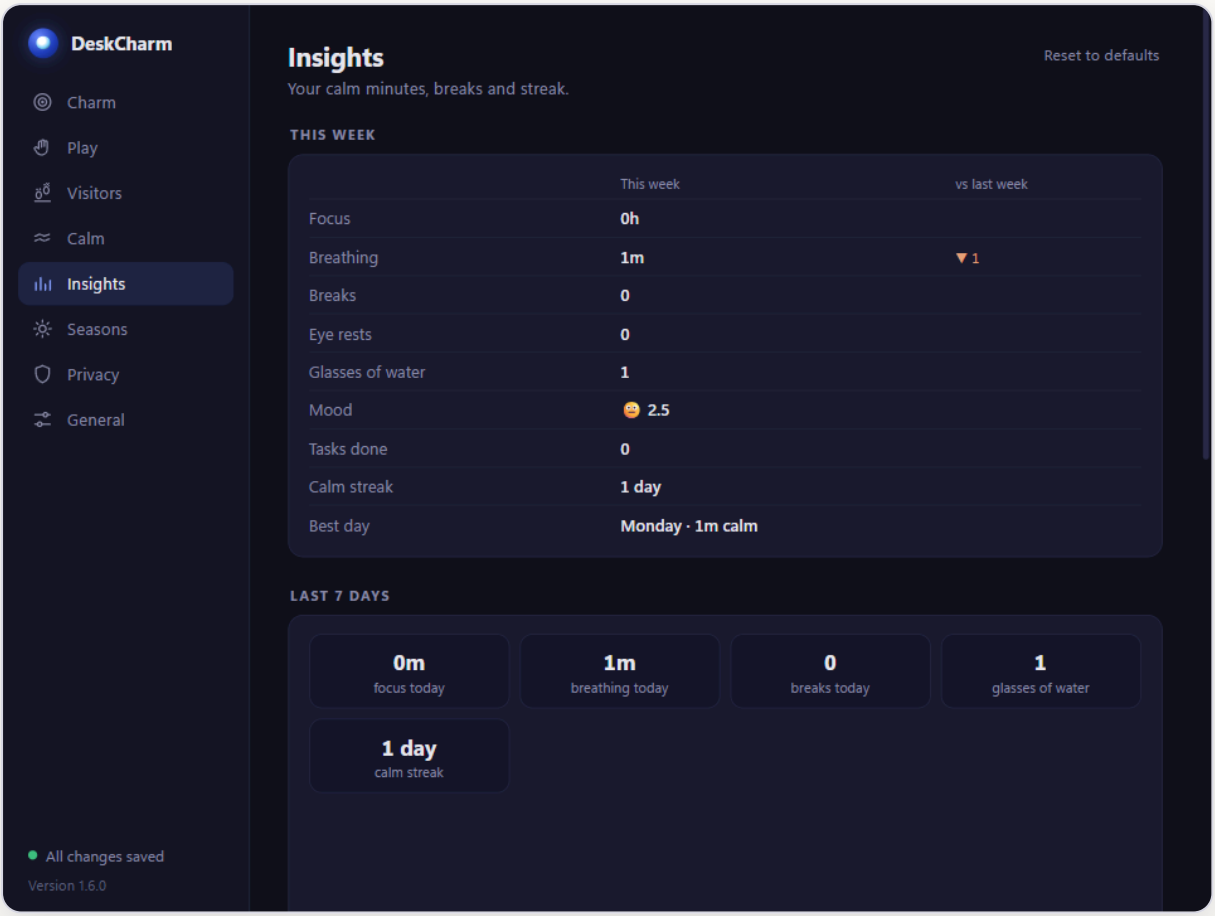


Figure 19 — Settings › Insights.

Card	What it shows / does	Default
This week	This week against last week (Monday–Sunday)	—
Last 7 days	Daily chart, today's calm activity, mood	—
Tasks done	Finished focus tasks	—
Counters	Each counter's count today against its goal, and the last 7 days as small bars	—
Your routines	Each tracked reminder: done today, current streak, the last 7 days as dots	—
App usage › Track app usage	Records which apps you use and for how long	Off
App usage › Nudge me when I switch apps a lot	Needs app tracking	Off
Your data › Delete all insights	Removes every recorded day (**Delete**, confirm)	—

SECTION 4.6

Seasons — "Seasons & surroundings"

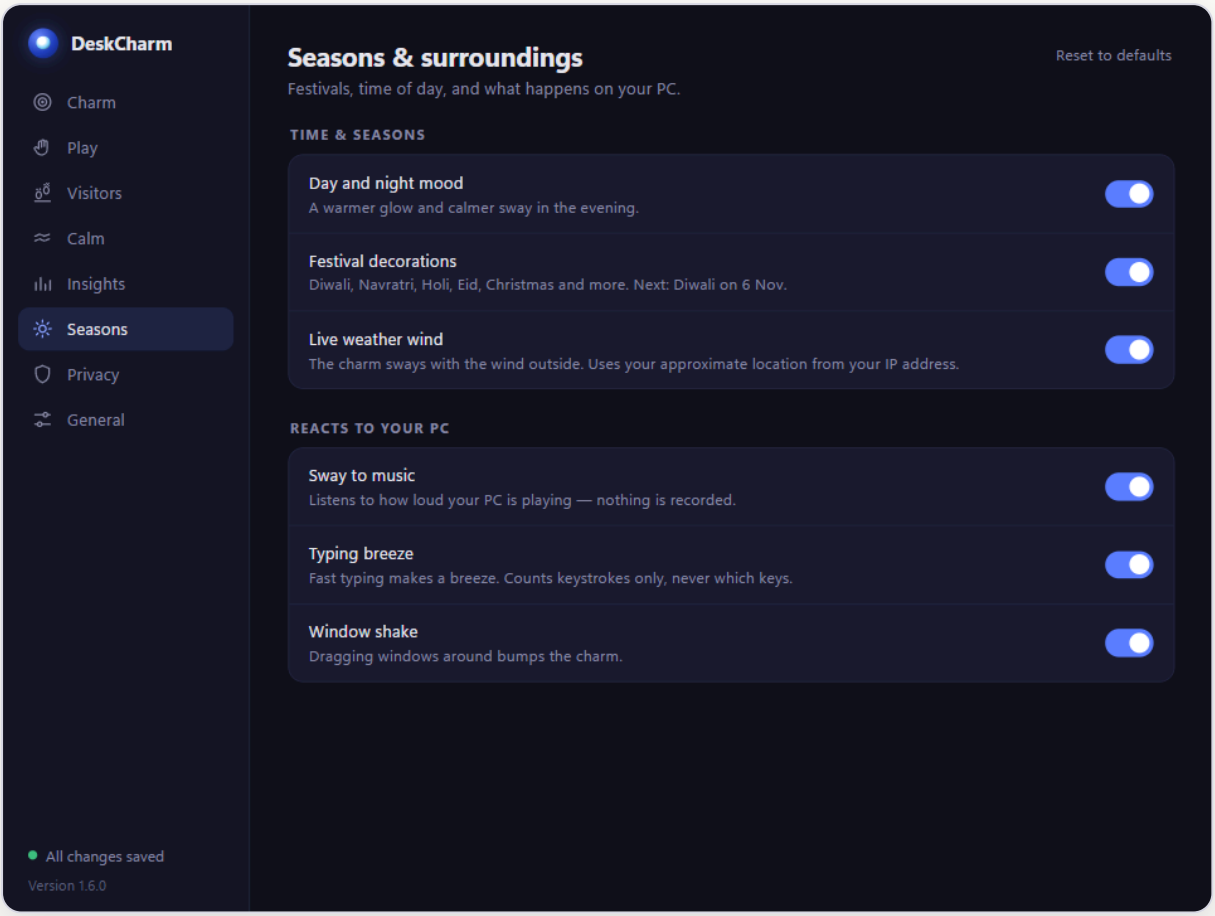


Figure 20 — Settings › Seasons.

Option	What it does	Default
Day and night mood	A warmer glow and calmer sway in the evening	On
Festival decorations	Diwali, Navratri, Holi, Eid, Christmas and more; also lets festival visitors come	On
Live weather wind	Sways with the real wind outside (approximate location from your IP)	Off
Reacts to your PC › Sway to music	Follows how loud your PC is playing; nothing is recorded	Off
Typing breeze	Fast typing makes a breeze; counts keystrokes, never which keys	Off
Window shake	Dragging windows bumps the charm	On

SECTION 4.7

Privacy — "Comfort & privacy"

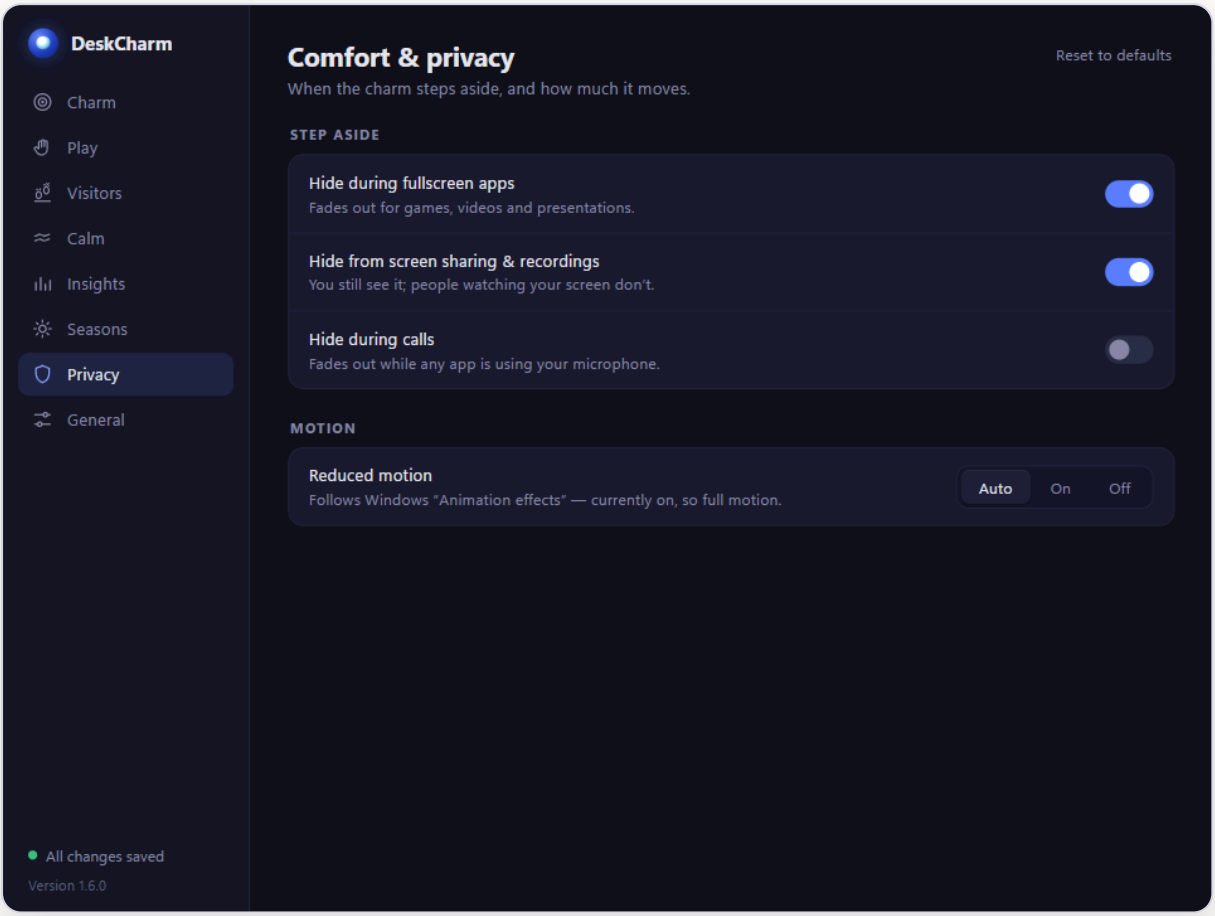


Figure 21 — Settings › Privacy.

Option	What it does	Default
Step aside › Hide during fullscreen apps	Fades out for games, videos and presentations	On
Hide from screen sharing & recordings	You still see it; people watching your screen do not	On
Hide during calls	Fades out while any app uses the microphone	Off
Motion › Reduced motion	Auto (follow Windows animation setting) / On / Off	Auto

SECTION 4.8

General — "Startup, shortcut, updates and about"

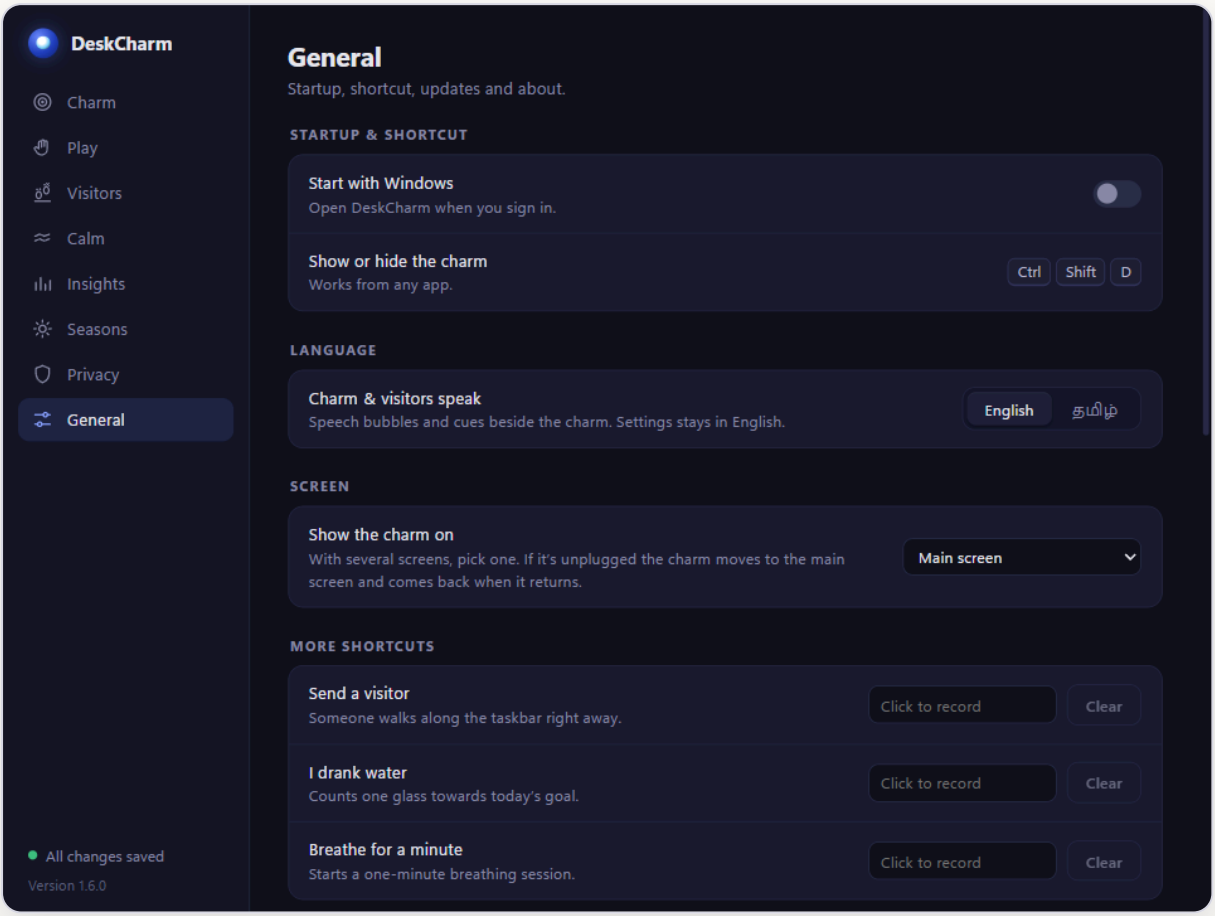


Figure 22 — Settings › General.

Section	Option	Default
Startup & shortcut	Start with Windows; shows whether **Ctrl+Shift+D** works	Off
Language	Charm & visitors speak: English / தமிழ்	English
Screen	Show the charm on: Main screen or a chosen screen	Main screen
More shortcuts	Send a visitor · I drank water · Breathe for a minute (record a key combination; **Clear**)	None
Updates	DeskCharm updates: **Check now** / Install	—
Backup & logs	**Export settings...**, **Import settings...**, **Open log folder**	—
First-run tips	**Show tips** replays the three tips	—
Help	**Report a problem...**	—
About	Version, links	—

Section	Option	Default
Reset	**Reset all** (click again to confirm). Your own charms are kept	—

If the chosen screen is unplugged, the charm moves to the main screen and returns when it comes back.



5

CHAPTER 5

Desk visitors

Little characters that stroll along your taskbar.

Visitors walk in along the top of the taskbar, stop, do a short act and walk off. Click a visitor to see its act again. Wave the cursor near one and it says hi. Fling the charm at one and it runs away.

Visitor	Group	What it does	Click
Cat (orange tabby)	Everyday	Stretches with a yawn, sits, licks a paw, gives a slow "cat kiss" blink	Replays
Baby elephant	Everyday	Trumpets, sprays water at the charm, stomps happily	Replays
Peacock	Everyday	Turns to you and fans its tail	Replays
Monkey	Everyday	Stops under the charm, leaps and steals its last bead; it comes back 10 s after he leaves	Gives the bead back at once ("Okay, okay!")
Yogi	Everyday	Floats in, three slow breaths, namaste. Also does stretch and posture nudges	Nudge: counts it done. Otherwise starts 1 min of breathing
Vijay	Wellness	The water buddy (below)	Replays
Chai-wala	Wellness	Rides in on a bicycle, rings the bell, offers chai. Comes only for break reminders	Starts the break
Eye-rest bird (myna)	Wellness	Lands and gazes far away for about 20 s (20-20-20)	—
Pongal pot carrier	Festival	The pot boils over, "Pongalo Pongal!"	Replays
Holi colour runner	Festival	Throws colour, "Bura na mano, Holi hai!"	Replays
Diwali lamp kid	Festival	Lights a second diya, "Happy Diwali"	Replays
Reindeer	Festival	Glowing nose, gift pops open, "Merry Christmas!"	Replays



Figure 23 — Vijay asking you to drink some water.

SECTION 5.1

Festival visitors

Festival visitors come only during their festival and only while **Festival decorations** is on. During a festival about half of all visits are festival visitors.

Festival	2026	2027	2028
Pongal	13–16 Jan	14–17 Jan	14–17 Jan
Holi	2–4 Mar	21–22 Mar	10–11 Mar
Diwali	6–10 Nov	27–31 Oct	15–19 Oct
Christmas	24–25 Dec	24–25 Dec	24–25 Dec

Eid, Navratri and New Year have decorations but no visitor.

SECTION 5.2

When visitors stay away

- **Quiet hours** (if on).
- **Pause visitors for 1 hour**.
- **Quiet during calls** (microphone in use) and **busy calendar events** (if on). Reminders from other features (water, stretch) wait until the call ends.
- When the overlay is hidden (fullscreen apps, calls, Hide).

You can always send one yourself: quick menu, middle-click, Settings, or a shortcut.

SECTION 5.3

Vijay, the water buddy

Every visit starts with "Vanakkam nanba! 🙏". With the water reminder on, he offers a tumbler: "Hey *name*, drink some water? 💧 " with **YES** / **NO**.

- **YES**: "Verithanam 🔥 ", one glass is counted, he waves bye.
- **NO**: "When should I come back?" — 15 min / 30 min / 1 hour (no choice in 12 s = 20 min). Then he is a little sad.
- No answer in 20 s: he asks again in 20 minutes.

A small ring with a droplet beside the charm's hook shows today's glasses against your goal. It resets each morning. Up to two counters with **Ring** on get their own small rings in the same row (three at most).



Figure 24 — A visitor asking a question with answer buttons.

SECTION 5.4

Visitors as reminders

Your own reminders can bring a visitor, who asks your text with **Done** / **Later**: pick one, or **Auto** to follow *Who visits for what*.

SECTION 5.5

Who visits for what

Every visitor that comes for a reason (water, stretch, posture, break, eye rest, reminders, focus guard, mood cheer, the morning hello, counters) is chosen in Settings › Visitors › **Who visits for what** (see chapter 4). Visitors that are switched off are never sent; if nobody is available, only the charm's cue shows.

6

CHAPTER 6

Calm tools

Breathing, focus, breaks, water and gentle reminders.



SECTION 6.1

Guided breathing

Start it from the quick menu (**Breathe ▸ 1 / 3 / 5 min**), Settings › Calm, or a shortcut. The charm glows: breathe in for 4 seconds, out for 6. A ring and "Breathe in… / Breathe out…" cues guide you. With two charms, both glow.

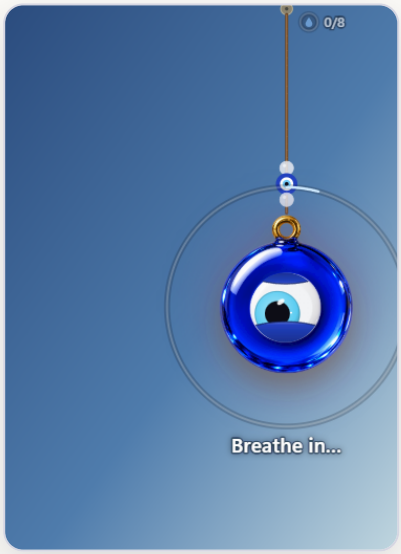


Figure 25 — A breathing session.

SECTION 6.2

Focus timer and tasks

Focus 25 / 5: 25 minutes of focus, then a 5-minute break, repeating until you stop it. When focus starts, a small window next to the charm asks **What are you working on?** Type a task or pick one from your list (or skip).

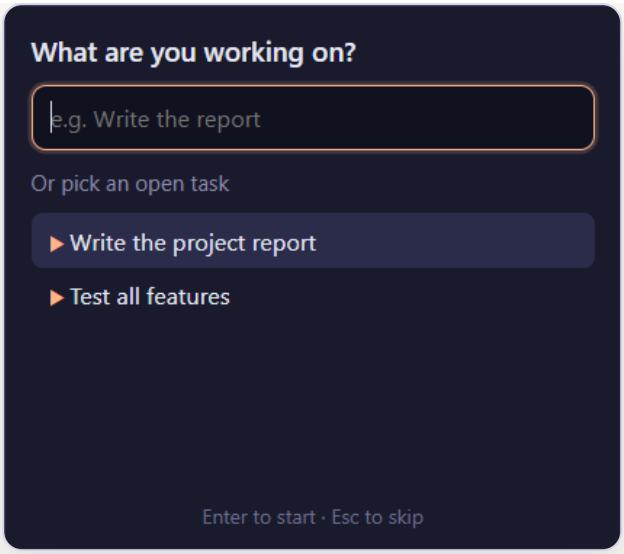


Figure 26 — The task prompt beside the charm.

During focus, the charm shows the timer and the task ("24:12 · Write report"). When the focus part ends it asks **Done? Click the charm ✓**. Click = done. Ignore = the task stays open and carries over. Finished tasks appear in Insights › Tasks done. Tasks can be up to 80 characters; up to 200 are kept, finished ones are removed after 30 days, and the quick menu (Tasks ▸) lists up to 6 open ones.

SECTION 6.3

Break reminders and eye rest

- **Break reminders**: every 45 minutes (by default) of screen time, the charm swings and glows and the chai-wala rides in. Click the charm or him to take the break.
- **Eye rest (20-20-20)**: every 20 minutes, the myna bird lands and gazes far away for 20 seconds. Look at something 20 feet away.

Reminder intervals count only time the charm is visible.

SECTION 6.4

Water reminder and ring

See *Vijay, the water buddy* above. The **I drank water** shortcut counts a glass without Vijay.

SECTION 6.5

Stretch and posture

The yogi floats in. Stretch: "Stretch with me 🙆" — arms up, side bend, neck roll. Posture: "Sit tall 🧘". Click him when done ("Nice! 💪"). If you ignore him he asks again after 15 minutes.

SECTION 6.6

Mood check-in

Once a day at or after the time you set (15:00 by default), at your first activity, the charm asks **How are you feeling?** with five faces under it. It does not ask during focus, breathing, calls, quiet hours or busy calendar time. Ignore it for 60 seconds and it waits until tomorrow. You can also log a mood any time from **How do you feel?** ▸.

- 😔 or 😟: soft eyes, "Breathe with me?" (click the charm for 1 minute of breathing), and maybe a cheer-up visitor (once a day).
- 🙂 or 😄: a happy eye and a sparkle.

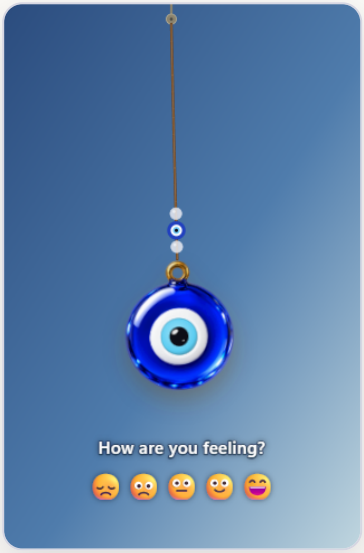


Figure 27 — The mood check-in faces under the charm.

SECTION 6.7

Daily ritual

Morning greeting, today's intention, evening wind-down and the Sunday weekly reflection card. See Settings › Calm › Daily ritual above.

SECTION 6.8

Ambience

Rain, wind, ocean, temple or chimes, synthesised live on your PC. It follows **Mute**, fades out when the charm is hidden, and can play automatically during breathing and focus.

SECTION 6.9

Your reminders

Settings › Calm › **Your reminders** › **+ Add reminder**. Each reminder has a text and a repeat:

Repeat	Example
Daily at a time	Every day at 09:00
On chosen weekdays at a time	Mon, Wed, Fri at 18:30
Every N minutes within a window	Every 90 min from 09:00 to 18:00 (5 min to 12 h)
Once at a date and time	2026-11-02 at 14:00

When one is due: a soft chime and your text beside the charm (exactly as typed), a Windows notification, and, if you chose a visitor, that visitor asks with **Done** / **Later**. **Later** asks again in 10 minutes. No answer for 2 minutes: asked once more after 10 minutes. Quiet hours do not apply; during a call it waits until the call ends. If the PC was off: a repeating reminder up to a little late still fires; a one-off fires if it is less than 2 hours late. Use **Test** in the dialog to try it.

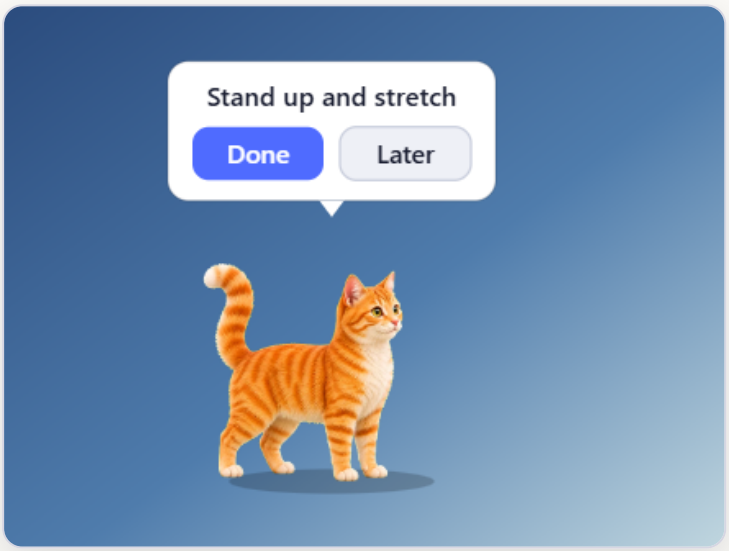


Figure 28 — A reminder beside the charm.

SECTION 6.10

Tracked reminders and streaks

Tick **Track it** on a reminder and each time it comes due is recorded once. It counts as **done** when you answer Done, even after Later. It counts as **missed** if you ignore it twice, if its next time comes while it is still unanswered, or if it is still unanswered at 23:59; if DeskCharm was closed or your PC slept past the end of the day, it counts as missed on the day it was due. Its streak counts the days on which every time was done; days it wasn't due are skipped, and today counts once it has a Done and no miss. Insights › **Your routines** shows each tracked reminder and This week adds a *Routines done* row. Free: 3 tracked reminders; Pro: unlimited.

SECTION 6.11

Counters

Count anything you want to do a few times a day: push-ups, prayers, pages read. Within each counter's hours, every *Ask every* minutes a visitor asks "*name*? *emoji*" (or your own question with Pro) with **YES** / **NO**. YES adds one, pulses its ring and shows "*name n/goal*". NO or no answer asks again after 20 minutes; once the goal is reached it stops asking for the day. Counts go to Insights › **Counters** (today and the last 7 days) and This week. Free: 1 counter; Pro: unlimited.

SECTION 6.12

Focus guard

Turn on **Nudge me back to focus** and list distracting apps (e.g. `discord.exe`). Only while the focus timer runs, DeskCharm checks the app in front every 2 seconds. If it is on your list, a visitor walks over: "Back to focus? 🎯" — at most once every 5 minutes. Only the program file name is compared; nothing is stored.

SECTION 6.13

Meeting quiet

Quiet during calls keeps visitors away while the microphone is in use. **Quiet during busy calendar events** reads your private iCal (.ics) link every 15 minutes (https only) and treats busy times as quiet hours. **Hide during calls** (Privacy page) hides the charm itself.



7

CHAPTER 7

Insights

Your calm minutes, breaks, water, mood and streak.

SECTION 7.1

What is recorded

Per day, always (it is part of the calm tools):

- Focus minutes and breathing minutes
- Breaks taken and dismissed; eye rests taken and dismissed
- Stress releases (smash to calm)
- Stretches and posture checks finished with the yogi (they count toward your streak and show in **This week**)
- Glasses of water
- Mood check-ins (sum, count and the last one)

Only if you turn on **Track app usage**: the names of apps in front (program or friendly name) with time per day, and app switches per hour. Window titles are never stored.

SECTION 7.2

Where and how long

Day files live in `%APPDATA%\com.deskcharm.desktop\insights\`, one JSON file per day. DeskCharm keeps today plus the 29 days before it (30 days) and deletes older files on its own.

SECTION 7.3

How to delete

PRIVACY

Settings › Insights › Your data › **Delete all insights**. Uninstalling DeskCharm deletes them too.

The **Today** item in the quick menu shows today's summary and your streak (consecutive days with calm activity).

8

CHAPTER 8

Language, shortcuts, backup and help



Language, shortcuts, backup and getting help.

SECTION 8.1

Language

Settings › General › Language › **Charm & visitors speak**: English or தமிழ் (Tamil). This changes the speech bubbles and cues on the desktop and the task prompt. The Settings window stays in English. Your reminder texts are shown exactly as you typed them.

SECTION 8.2

Shortcuts

Shortcut	What it does
Ctrl+Shift+D	Show or hide the charm (fixed)
Send a visitor	Set your own in Settings › General › More shortcuts
I drank water	Counts one glass
Breathe for a minute	Starts 1 minute of breathing

SECTION 8.3

Backup and restore

Settings › General › Backup & logs:

- **Export settings...** saves every setting and your own charm images into one `.deskcharm` file (default name `DeskCharm settings.deskcharm`).
- **Import settings...** restores it. Any bad field keeps its default.

> **NOTE**
> Tasks, reminders and insights are not part of the backup.

SECTION 8.4

Error log

Errors are written to `%APPDATA%\com.deskcharm.desktop\logs\deskcharm.log`. It is capped at 1 MB (one older `deskcharm.log.old` is kept). **Open log folder** opens it. Nothing is sent.

SECTION 8.5

Report a problem

Settings › General › Help › **Report a problem…** opens a pre-filled GitHub issue in your browser with the version, Windows version and a summary of non-personal settings. Your name, calendar, intention, apps and charm names are left out. Please attach `deskcharm.log`. You can also email **support@deskcharm.in** (Settings › General › About › **Email support**).



9

CHAPTER 9

Privacy and your data

What is stored, where it lives and what goes online.

All DeskCharm files are in `%APPDATA%\com.deskcharm.desktop\` (for example `C:\Users\you\AppData\Roaming\com.deskcharm.desktop`).

File or folder	What it holds
`config.json`	Every setting (the AppConfig fields in the appendix), including your name, intention, calendar link and focus-guard app list
`tasks.json`	Your focus tasks (open and recently finished)
`reminders.json`	Your reminders and their repeat rules
`insights\YYYY-MM-DD.json`	One file per day of insights (30 days kept)
`charms\`	Images you added under **My charms**
`logs\deskcharm.log` (+ `.log.old`)	Error log

PRIVACY

A few small things live in the app's web storage (WebView2 `localStorage`): today's water count, and when the mood check-in and daily ritual last ran. The visitor log ("Visits today") is in memory only and is forgotten when DeskCharm closes.

Network use (everything else stays on your PC):

When	Where to	What is sent
Update check (start + every 6 h)	GitHub Releases	A normal download request
Live weather wind (opt-in)	ipwho.is (or ipapi.co), api.open-meteo.com	Your IP address; then the approximate coordinates
Busy calendar quiet (opt-in)	Your .ics link	A download request

When	Where to	What is sent
Report a problem	Your browser opens github.com	Only what you submit

TIP

Hide from screen sharing & recordings (on by default) also means the charm does not appear in your own screenshots.



10

CHAPTER 10

Troubleshooting and FAQ

Quick answers when something feels off.

> ⚠ **WARNING**
> **Windows says "Windows protected your PC".** The installer is not code-signed. Click **More info › Run anyway**.

I can't see the charm. Press **Ctrl+Shift+D**. Check the tray menu says **Hide** (not **Show**). Fullscreen apps and calls may hide it (Privacy page). If you use several screens, check Settings › General › Screen.

The charm is not in my screenshot or screen share. That is **Hide from screen sharing & recordings**. Turn it off on the Privacy page.

Ctrl+Shift+D does nothing. Another app has the shortcut. Settings › General shows "Unavailable — another app is using this shortcut."

Clicks near the charm don't reach my desktop. Only the charm itself catches the mouse. If you notice otherwise, please report it.

No visitors come. Check Visitors is on, quiet hours, **Pause visitors**, calls and calendar quiet. On **Rarely** they come about once an hour. Use **Send a visitor** to test.

Festival visitors never come. They only come during their festival dates with Festival decorations on.

No sound. Check **Mute** in the quick menu and per-visitor Sounds.

Start with Windows does nothing (Store version, later). Turn it on in Windows Settings › Apps › Startup.

My settings got lost. Import your backup. If `config.json` is damaged, DeskCharm uses defaults for anything it can't read.

The charm uses CPU. When nothing moves, the overlay stops drawing. The idle sway stops after a minute without mouse movement. Turn off Sway to music and Typing breeze if not needed.

How do I start over? Settings › General › Reset › **Reset all**.



PART 2

Developing DeskCharm

For developers new to the code: how DeskCharm is built and how to change it.



11

CHAPTER 11

Tech stack and repo map

Tauri, Rust and plain JavaScript — and where it all lives.

Layer	Technology
Desktop shell	Tauri 2 (Rust), WebView2 on Windows
Native code	Rust (`src-tauri/src`), crates: serde, parking_lot, chrono, reqwest (rustls), Tauri plugins (single-instance, dialog, global-shortcut, autostart, updater, notification)
Overlay and Settings	Plain HTML, CSS and ES modules. No framework, no bundler (`frontendDist` is `src/`)
Tests	Node's built-in test runner; `cargo test`
Image tools	Node scripts using `sharp`
Installer	NSIS (per-user), Tauri updater

SECTION 11.1

Repo map

```
amulet/
├─ src/                 Web front end served as-is
│  ├─ index.html        Overlay window page
│  ├─ settings.html     Settings window (pages, ui helpers, core sections)
│  ├─ task-prompt.html  Small "What are you working on?" window
│  ├─ charms.js         Charm catalog (categories, styling, eyes)
│  ├─ themes.js         Themes
│  ├─ *.png             Charm images (600×670)
│  ├─ visitors/         Visitor sprite atlases (<id>-real.webp + .json)
│  ├─ js/               Overlay code (app.js, physics, features, visitors)
│  └─ settings/         Settings sections (one file per area) + settings.css
├─ src-tauri/           Rust app: lib.rs (config, menus, setup) + one module per
feature
├─ test/                Node tests (*.test.mjs) and dom.js shim
├─ scripts/             Build helpers (site demo, i18n, sprites, charms, guide)
├─ art/                 Source renders: art/charms, art/visitors/<id>
├─ docs/                Website (GitHub Pages), changelog, QA checklist, this guide
├─ packaging/msix/      Microsoft Store packaging (for later)
└─ .github/workflows/   ci.yml, release.yml
```

SECTION 11.2

Key files

File	Purpose
`src-tauri/src/lib.rs`	`AppConfig`, config load/save, tray, quick menu, Ctrl+Shift+D, cursor polling, `invoke_handler`, `setup`
`src-tauri/tauri.conf.json`	Windows (main, settings), CSP, bundle, updater
`src/js/app.js`	Overlay bootstrap, 120 Hz physics loop, render loop, `applyConfig`, `world`
`src/js/features.js`	Feature registry
`src/js/features/*.js`	One file per feature (wellness, visitors, water, mood, ...)
`src/js/interaction.js`	Mouse: hover, drag, fling, squeeze, bead slide, clicks, context menu
`src/js/rope.js`, `charm.js`	Rope physics and charm drawing
`src/js/overlay-ui.js`	Cues, rings, timers beside the charm
`src/js/stillness.js`	Decides when the overlay may sleep
`src/js/visitors/engine.js`	Visitor registry and runner (header documents a visitor definition)
`src/js/visitors/sprite.js`	Sprite-atlas visitors

File	Purpose
`src/js/i18n.js`, `i18n-ta.js`	`t()` / `tx()` and the Tamil strings
`src/js/embed-host.js`	Stand-in for Tauri when the overlay runs in a normal browser
`src/js/dev.js`	`DEV` flag for console helpers
`src/settings.html`	Settings shell, `DeskSettings.register`, `ui` helpers



12

CHAPTER 12

Architecture

Windows, events, commands and the overlay loop.

SECTION 12.1

Windows

Label	Page	What it is
`main`	`index.html`	The overlay: transparent, no frame, always on top, not in the taskbar, covers one monitor. Click-through except where the charm is
`settings`	`settings.html`	Created on first open. After it has been closed for 5 minutes its webview is destroyed to save memory
`task-prompt`	`task-prompt.html?lang=`	Tiny always-on-top window by the charm when focus starts (the overlay cannot take typing)

SECTION 12.2

Click-through

The overlay starts with `setIgnoreCursorEvents(true)`. Rust polls the cursor every 8 ms and sends `cursor-pos` [x, y] in overlay CSS pixels. `app.js` hit-tests the charms, visitors and UI and turns cursor events on only while the cursor is over something clickable.

SECTION 12.3

Rust ↔ JS: important events

Event	Direction	Payload / meaning
`request-config`	JS → Rust	Ask for the config; Rust answers `current-config`
`current-config`	Rust → JS	Full `AppConfig`
`save-config`	Settings → Rust	Full config to save
`config-changed`	Rust → JS	Saved config broadcast

Event	Direction	Payload / meaning
`config-save-result`	Rust → Settings	`true` / `false` (drives "Saved")
`preview-config`	Settings → overlay	Live preview before saving
`cursor-pos`	Rust → overlay	`[x, y]`
`show-quick-menu`	overlay → Rust	Right-click on the charm
`wellness-command` / `wellness-state`	Rust → overlay / overlay → Rust	Breathe, focus; what is running
`visitor-command`	Rust/Settings → overlay	`{ action: 'send', id? }`, `pause`, `resume`
`visitor-job-command`	Settings → overlay	Try it: `{ job, id?, message? }` runs that job now through its feature
`desk:visitor-job` (window)	overlay features → `features/visitors.js`	`{ job, id?, data?, onAnswer? }`: one resolver (`src/js/visitor-jobs.js` `visitorFor`) picks the visitor; specialists keep their acts, others run the generic act (`src/js/visitors/jobs.js`); sets `detail.sent` / `detail.visitor`
`visitor-visited`	overlay → Rust	Visit log entry
`water-command`	→ overlay	`{ action: 'ask' }` or `'drank'`
`nudge-command`	Settings → overlay	`{ kind: 'stretch' | 'posture' }`
`insights-event { kind: 'counter', id }`	overlay → Rust	One YES for a counter (`Day.counters`); tracked reminders are recorded by `reminders.rs` (`Day.reminders`)
`insights-event`	overlay → Rust	`{ kind, minutes? }`
`insights-today`, `insights-nudge`	Rust → overlay	Today card, switch nudge
`mood-log` / `mood-command`	overlay → Rust / Rust → overlay	Mood check-in
`task-prompt`, `task-chosen`, `task-current`, `task-command`	both	Focus tasks
`reminder-due` / `reminder-ack`	Rust → overlay / overlay → Rust	Your reminders
`env-call`, `env-busy`, `env-distraction`	Rust → overlay	Microphone in use, calendar busy, focus guard

Event	Direction	Payload / meaning
`env-audio-level`, `env-typing-rate`, `env-window-move`	Rust → overlay	Reacts to your PC
`smart-hide`, `system-motion`	Rust → overlay	Fullscreen/call hiding; Windows animations setting
`onboarding-done`	overlay → Rust	First-run tips finished
`update-available`, `open-settings`	Rust → overlay / overlay → Rust	Update cue
`hotkey-status`, `settings-opened`, `show-about-tab`	Rust → Settings	Shortcut state, focus Settings

SECTION 12.4

Commands (`invoke`)

All in one `invoke_handler` in `lib.rs` (a second call would replace it):

Area	Commands
Config	`config_defaults`, `open_link`
Custom charms	`custom_charms_dir`, `add_custom_charm`, `delete_custom_charm`
Insights	`insights_day`, `insights_range`, `insights_clear`
Updates	`update_status`, `update_check`, `update_install`
Tasks	`tasks_list`, `tasks_add`, `tasks_complete`, `tasks_delete`, `tasks_summary`
Reminders	`reminders_get`, `reminders_set`, `reminder_test`
Other	`app_platform`, `wellness_state`, `visitor_log`, `log_js_error`, `open_log_folder`, `export_settings`, `import_settings`, `calendar_test`, `list_monitors`

SECTION 12.5

Config flow

1. Rust loads `config.json` into `AppConfig` (`#[serde(default)]` , so missing fields get defaults), then `normalized()` .
2. The overlay and Settings emit `request-config` ; Rust replies `current-config` .
3. Overlay: `applyConfig(cfg)` in `app.js` applies the core fields and calls every feature's `onConfig(cfg, world)` .

4. Settings: each section's `apply(cfg)` fills its controls. On any change, Settings builds the config by calling every section's `collect(out)`, sends `preview-config` after 30 ms, and `save-config` after 450 ms.
5. Rust saves (atomic write), applies autostart, hotkeys and monitor, then emits `config-changed`.

Quick-menu toggles (Mute, Two charms) change the Rust state directly and emit `current-config`.

SECTION 12.6

The overlay loop and sleep

`app.js` runs physics at a fixed 120 Hz step and renders once per animation frame. To keep idle CPU near zero, the loop stops when nothing can change. `stillness.js` decides (pure, tested): ropes at rest, cursor quiet for 1 s, no `keepAwake` deadline. Idle sway turns off after 60 s without mouse input so the overlay can sleep. Any config, event or input wakes it. A feature that animates must call `world.keepAwake(ms)`.

SECTION 12.7

Features registry

```
import { registerFeature } from '../features.js';
registerFeature({
  onInit(world) {},           // once, before the first frame
  onConfig(cfg, world) {},    // every config / preview (cfg may be partial)
  onStep(world) {},           // each 120 Hz physics step
  onRender(world, now, dt) {} // each frame
});
```

Each feature file is imported once from `app.js`. `world` holds `charms`, `layers` (back, charms, front, ui), `interaction`, `config`, `emit`, `listen`, `hidden`, `reducedMotion`, `keepAwake` and more.

SECTION 12.8

Overlay UI

`overlay-ui.js` draws cues (short text), progress rings and timers beside the charm. `OverlayUI.setCue` passes text through `t()`.

SECTION 12.9

Language (i18n)

- `t(text, vars)` translates when shown: `t('{n}/{goal} glasses today 💧', { n, goal })`.
- `tx(text)` only marks a string for the extractor (returns it unchanged); translate later with `t()`.
- Tamil strings live in `src/js/i18n-ta.js` (English → Tamil).

- `node scripts/i18n-strings.mjs` lists overlay strings missing in Tamil; `--check` fails if any (tested by `npm test`).



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CHAPTER 13

How to ...

Recipes for the changes you will make most often.

SECTION 13.1

Run in development

```
npm install
npx tauri dev
```

> **NOTE**
> The dev build serves from `127.0.0.1`, so `DEV` is true and console helpers exist.

SECTION 13.2

Debug

- Open the overlay's DevTools: start with `WEBVIEW2_ADDITIONAL_BROWSER_ARGUMENTS=--remote-debugging-port=9333` and open `http://localhost:9333` in Edge/Chrome.
- Console helpers (dev only, from `DEV` in `src/js/dev.js`): `DeskVisitors` (`send`, `list`, `inQuietHours`, `greet` ...), `DeskWater.now()`, `DeskNudges.now()`, `DeskReminders.fire()`, `DeskTips.start()`, `DeskRitual`, `DeskLiving`, `DeskSeasons.previewFestival('holi')` / `previewHour(21.5)`.
- Without Tauri: serve `src/` with any static server and open `index.html?embed&visitors` (visitors on). `DeskEmbed.fire('preview-config', {...})` applies config. `index.html?festival=diwali` previews a festival. `settings.html` opens without Tauri (events do nothing).

SECTION 13.3

Add a charm

1. Add an entry to a category in `src/charms.js` (`id`, `name`, `image`, `weight`, rope and bead styling; optional `eye` for a living eye).
2. Make the art (`src/CHARM-ART.md`, "Producing the art"): render on flat chroma green (magenta if the subject has green), split sheets with `node scripts/charms/split-sheet.mjs`, cut out with `node scripts/charms/cutout.mjs <render> src/<id>.png [green|magenta]` → 600×670 PNG,

ring top at y≈8.

3. Keep sources in `art/charms/`; run `node scripts/sprites/compress.mjs art/charms`.
4. Check it on dark and light backgrounds.

SECTION 13.4

Add a visitor

1. Read the header of `src/js/visitors/engine.js` (definition fields: `id`, `name`, `group`, `fact`, `act`, `hit`, `onClick`, `festival`, `cueOnly` …).
2. Realistic visitors use `sprite.js` (see `vijay.js`): render poses on green in `art/visitors/<id>/` with a `sprites.json` spec.
3. Pack: `node scripts/sprites/pack.mjs art/visitors/<id>/sprites.json` → `src/visitors/<id>-real.webp` + `.json`.
4. Compress sources: `node scripts/sprites/compress.mjs art/visitors/<id>`.
5. Create `src/js/visitors/<id>.js` calling `registerVisitor(...)` and import it where the others are imported.
6. Wrap bubble text for `t()` and add Tamil entries.

SECTION 13.5

Add a feature

1. `src/js/features/<name>.js` with `registerFeature({...})`; one `import './features/<name>.js';` in `app.js`.
2. Config field in `AppConfig` (`lib.rs`) **and** its default in `impl Default`. Old configs keep working thanks to `#[serde(default)]`.
3. Settings section: `src/settings/<name>.js` with `DeskSettings.register`, plus a `<script>` tag near the end of `settings.html`.
4. Native part (if needed): a Rust module `src-tauri/src/<name>.rs` with `listen` / `init`, and for menu items `insert_menu_items` / `append_menu_items` + `on_menu` with a `MENU_PREFIX` (see `wellness.rs`). Wire it in `lib.rs` (mod, setup, `on_menu_event`, commands).
5. Overlay strings via `t()` / `tx()` with Tamil entries in `i18n-ta.js`.
6. Tests for real logic (pure functions, schedules) in `test/` and `#[cfg(test)]`.

SECTION 13.6

Add a Settings section

```
window.DeskSettings.register({
  page: 'calm',            // charm | play | visitors | calm | insights | seasons |
privacy | general
  order: 40,               // position on the page
  label: 'My section',
  render(body, ui) {
    this.t = ui.toggle(body, 'Do the thing', null, 'One-line explanation.');
  },
  apply(cfg) { this.t.set(cfg.my_field); },
  collect(out) { out.my_field = this.t.get(); },
});
```

TIP

Helpers: `ui.toggle`, `ui.slider`, `ui.segmented`, `ui.row` (→ `{ row, control, setDesc }`), `ui.button(parent, text, 'primary'|'ghost'|'danger', onClick)`. Check an existing section (e.g. `settings/wellness.js`) for the exact control API.



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CHAPTER 14

Testing

The checks to run before you push.

Check	Command	What it covers
JS tests	`npm test`	`node --test "test/*.test.mjs"` ; import `test/dom.js` first for a minimal DOM
Syntax	`node --check <file>`	Every JS file you touch
Rust tests	`cargo test --lib` (in `src-tauri`)	Config compatibility, reminders, calendar, tasks, logs …
Tamil strings	`node scripts/i18n-strings.mjs`	0 missing
Demo sync	`node scripts/build-site-demo.mjs --check`	`docs/demo` matches `src`

CI (`.github/workflows/ci.yml`) runs on push to master and pull requests, on Windows, macOS and Linux: `node --check` on all front-end files, `npm test` , demo check (Linux), `cargo check --locked` , `cargo test --locked --lib` .

> **NOTE**
> **Manual QA**: `docs/QA.md` is the checklist to run on the installed build before every release.

> **TIP**
> **Visual checks**: serve `src/` statically and open `index.html?embed&visitors` or `settings.html` in headless Edge (`msedge --headless=new`) to take screenshots. Look at every one.



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CHAPTER 15

Building and releasing

From npm run build to a published release.

- `npm run build` (= `tauri build`) makes the NSIS installer in `src-tauri/target/release/bundle/nsis/`.
- Updater artifacts are signed. Set `TAURI_SIGNING_PRIVATE_KEY` (and `TAURI_SIGNING_PRIVATE_KEY_PASSWORD`) before building; the public key is in `tauri.conf.json`. Keep the private key safe — without it, installed copies cannot update.
- **Release workflow** (`release.yml`): pushing a tag `v*` builds, signs and creates a draft GitHub release with `latest.json`. Installed copies see the update only after the draft is published.

Version bump — change all of these:

File	Where
`package.json`	`"version"`
`src-tauri/tauri.conf.json`	`"version"`
`src-tauri/Cargo.toml`	`version` (Cargo.lock follows)
`src/settings.html`	`var VERSION` and the `Version x.y.z` label

Then update `docs/changelog.html`, run `node scripts/build-site-demo.mjs` so the website demo (`docs/demo`) matches, and update the website pages in `docs/` if features changed. Run `docs/QA.md`.

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CHAPTER 16

Conventions and gotchas

Rules that keep DeskCharm healthy.



- **Click-through**: the overlay ignores the mouse except over hit areas. New clickable things need a hit area, or clicks fall through to the desktop.
- **Capture exclusion**: with **Hide from screen sharing** on (default), screenshots and screen recorders do not show the overlay. Turn it off for screenshots.
- **Release builds use** `panic = "abort"`: a Rust panic closes the app. Avoid `unwrap()` on anything that can fail. The panic hook writes it to the log first.
- `keepAwake`: the overlay sleeps when still. Animations must call `world.keepAwake(ms)` or they freeze.
- **Green vs magenta keying**: art with green in it must be rendered on magenta.
- **Config compatibility**: never rename or remove an `AppConfig` field; add new ones with a default. Tests check that `{}` and old configs load.
- **One** `invoke_handler`: add commands to the existing list.
- **Shared files** (`lib.rs`, `settings.html`, `app.js`, `i18n-ta.js`): keep edits small.
- **Overlay strings**: always `t()` / `tx()` with a Tamil entry; reminder texts are shown as typed.
- **Reduced motion**: read `world.reducedMotion` and offer a calm version (fade instead of move).
- **Privacy**: no analytics; any new network use must be opt-in and listed in the CSP `connect-src`.
- **Single instance**: a second launch opens Settings; test with the installed build.



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CHAPTER 17

Roadmap and glossary

Where DeskCharm is going, and the words we use.

See `ROADMAP.md` for plans and `docs/changelog.html` for what shipped.

Term	Meaning
Overlay	The transparent always-on-top window with the charm
Charm	The swinging object on a string
Nazar	The blue eye charm that wards off the evil eye
Visitor	A small character walking on the taskbar
Quick menu	The charm's right-click menu
Feature	A JS module registered with `registerFeature`
Section	A Settings card registered with `DeskSettings.register`
Cue	Short text shown beside the charm
Quiet hours	Times with no scheduled visitors
Smart hide	Fading out for fullscreen apps or calls
Embed	Running the overlay in a normal browser page (`?embed`)
Atlas	A WebP grid of pre-rendered visitor poses

A

APPENDIX

AppConfig fields

Every setting saved in config.json.



All fields of `AppConfig` in `src-tauri/src/lib.rs`, saved in `config.json`.

Field	Default	Meaning
`position`	`"top-right"`	Corner the charm hangs from (`top-left` / `top-right`)
`idle_animation`	`true`	Gentle idle sway
`cursor_interaction`	`true`	Swing when the cursor passes
`sound_effects`	`true`	Sounds on (false = muted)
`auto_start`	`false`	Start with Windows
`opacity`	`1.0`	Charm opacity
`theme`	`""`	Applied theme id (`""` = none / customised)
`charm_style`	`null`	Theme rope and bead style over both charms
`accent_glow`	`""`	Theme glow colour `#rrggbb`
`birth_date`	`""`	Birthday `MM-DD` (Cosmic theme)
`charm_size`	`100`	Charm size %
`string_length`	`70`	String length %
`charm`	`"nazar-blue"`	Main charm id
`charm_data`	`null`	Main charm's catalog data
`offset`	`0`	Nudge sideways (px)
`drag_interaction`	`true`	Drag, fling & squeeze
`second_charm`	`""`	Charm 2 id (remembered when off)
`second_charm_data`	`null`	Charm 2 data

Field	Default	Meaning
`charm_count`	`0` → `1`	1 or 2 charms (0 = unset, normalised to 1)
`second_place`	`"beside"`	`beside` / `opposite`
`second_size`	`0` → charm size	Charm 2 size % (0 = copy main)
`second_length`	`0` → string length	Charm 2 string % (0 = copy main)
`melody_chimes`	`true`	Melody chimes
`break_reminders`	`false`	Break reminders
`break_interval_min`	`45`	Minutes between breaks
`eye_rest`	`false`	20-20-20 eye rest
`music_sway`	`false`	Sway to music
`typing_breeze`	`false`	Typing breeze
`window_shake`	`true`	Window shake
`day_night`	`true`	Day and night mood
`festival_themes`	`true`	Festival decorations and visitors
`weather_wind`	`false`	Live weather wind
`custom_charms`	`[]`	Your charms `{ id, name, file, weight }`
`hide_fullscreen`	`true`	Hide during fullscreen apps
`hide_from_capture`	`true`	Hide from screen sharing & recordings
`hide_during_calls`	`false`	Hide during calls
`reduced_motion`	`"auto"`	`auto` / `on` / `off`
`app_tracking`	`false`	Track app usage
`switch_nudges`	`false`	Nudge on frequent app switching
`visitors`	`true`	Visitors on
`visitor_frequency`	`"rare"`	`rare` / `sometimes` / `often`
`visitor_size`	`"m"`	`s` / `m` / `l`
`visitor_direction`	`"ltr"`	`ltr` / `rtl` / `random`
`visitor_stop`	`"center"`	`left` / `center` / `right` / `random`
`visitor_sounds`	`true`	Visitor sounds

Field	Default	Meaning
`visitor_bubbles`	`true`	Speech bubbles
`visitor_tricks`	`true`	Charm tricks
`visitor_reactions`	`true`	Reactions
`visitor_quiet`	`false`	Quiet hours on
`visitor_quiet_from`	`"22:00"`	Quiet hours start
`visitor_quiet_to`	`"07:00"`	Quiet hours end
`visitor_prefs`	`{}`	Per-visitor overrides (only what differs)
`water_reminder`	`true`	Water reminder
`water_interval_min`	`60`	Minutes between asks
`water_goal`	`8`	Glasses per day
`user_name`	`""`	What visitors call you
`onboarding_done`	`false`	First-run tips shown
`living_charm`	`true`	Living eye / face
`ambience`	`"off"`	`off` / `rain` / `wind` / `ocean` / `temple` / `chimes`
`ambience_volume`	`40`	0–100
`ambience_with_sessions`	`true`	Ambience during breathing & focus
`ritual_greeting`	`true`	Morning greeting
`ritual_intention`	`true`	Today's intention
`daily_intention`	`null`	`{ day: "YYYY-MM-DD", text }`
`ritual_winddown`	`false`	Evening wind-down
`ritual_winddown_time`	`"21:30"`	Wind-down time
`ritual_weekly`	`true`	Weekly reflection
`stretch_reminders`	`false`	Stretch reminders
`stretch_interval_min`	`60`	Minutes between stretches
`posture_reminders`	`false`	Posture reminders
`posture_interval_min`	`30`	Minutes between posture checks
`focus_guard`	`false`	Focus guard
`focus_guard_apps`	`[]`	Distracting exe names

Field	Default	Meaning
`visitors_quiet_in_calls`	`true`	Quiet during calls
`calendar_quiet`	`false`	Quiet during busy calendar events
`calendar_ics_url`	`""`	Private .ics link
`hotkey_visitor`	`""`	Shortcut: send a visitor (`""` = off)
`hotkey_water`	`""`	Shortcut: I drank water
`hotkey_breathe`	`""`	Shortcut: breathe for a minute
`ui_language`	`"en"`	`en` / `ta`
`monitor`	`""`	Screen name (`""` = main screen)
`mood_checkin`	`true`	Daily mood check-in
`mood_time`	`"15:00"`	Ask from this time
`visitor_mode`	`"auto"`	Who visits for what: `auto` / `favourite` / `custom` (Pro; free = Auto)
`visitor_favourite`	`""`	Favourite visitor id (`""` = Auto)
`visitor_jobs`	`{}`	Custom: `{ job: id | "auto" | "charm" }`; jobs `water`, `stretch`, `posture`, `break`, `eye_rest`, `reminder`, `focus_nudge`, `mood_cheer`, `greeting`, `counter`
`visitor_job_messages`	`{}`	Pro: `{ job: text }` shown as typed
`visitor_lines`	`{}`	Pro: `{ visitor id: { hello, bye } }` shown as typed
`counters`	`[]`	`[{ id, name, emoji, goal, every_min, from, to, visitor, message, ring }]` (1 free, unlimited with Pro)